Fw: Updated coding from NTU for thought suppresion RRR

Adam Wang <adam.wang@jcu.edu.au>

Wed 22-May-24 6:06 PM

To:Kaiqin Chan <Kaiqin.chan@jcu.edu.au>

1 attachments (29 KB)

RRR results input spreadsheet Study 2_NTU_RevisedMay2024.xlsx;

Hi Kaiqin

Here is another lab's updated data after correcting for an initial mistake

Cheers
Adam

From: Sarah Chan <sarahethanchan@gmail.com>
Sent: Wednesday, May 22, 2024 5:20 PM
To: Adam Wang <adam.wang@jcu.edu.au>
Subject: Updated coding from NTU for thought suppresion RRR

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Dear Adam,

I hope you've been well! Please find attached the updated re-scored data from our team at NTU. The same two RAs helped with re-coding the audio files for the target words of "food" and "diseases" using a broad strategy. Initially they had scored it using a narrow strategy (my mistake in providing the wrong instructions, sorry).

Just to share some feedback - they separately shared their concerns about the subjectivity of coding and being unsure what should count. And indeed there were large discrepancies between their scoring. Nonetheless, both RAs and myself had a meeting to discuss and resolve the discrepancies - resulting in the final scores in the sheet.

All the best for the last leap of this project!

Warm wishes,
Sarah

On Wed, Mar 27, 2024 at 4:18 PM Adam Wang <adam.wang@jcu.edu.au> wrote:

> Thanks for the update Sarah! Its a big project and there are many things that could go wrong and do go wrong, so these are very much expected, as long as we identify them early and try to remedy the issues, all is good.
>
> In terms of a deadline, it is the same, so as long as we get the results by end of May 2024 it should be fine.

Appreciate your help, thanks again!
Adam

From: Sarah Chan <sarahethanchan@gmail.com>
Sent: Wednesday, March 27, 2024 3:41 PM
To: Adam Wang <adam.wang@jcu.edu.au>
Subject: Re: Scoring strategy for Wang et al RRR on the ironic effects of thought suppression

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Hi Adam,

I have to take responsibility for this. As part of the coding protocol and instructions that I provided, I explicitly told them to count only the exact word. I've double-checked with the RAs and they confirmed that during the experiment they followed the verbatim instructions ("*...Every time you mention gorilla/tiger/a food/a disease or have gorilla/tiger/a food/a disease come to mind, please ring the bell on the table before you*"). However, neither they nor I had suspected the key difference between broad/narrow categories when it came to coding.

So it was primarily my oversight for informing them to code only the word, and not all subordinate words. I'm sorry for this. I'll take this up with Noah from NTU, who is the direct supervisor for both RAs, and inform him of my oversight. I'll then seek his permission to ask the RAs if they're able to help re-code the necessary audio files. Can I just check when you need the re-coding to be done by?

Since this is completely my oversight and given that the files will be re-coded, I will fill up Ian Hussey's survey and indicate that scoring at our site was done in the prescribed manner where tiger/gorilla is narrowly scored, and food/diseases is broadly scored.

Best,
Sarah

On Tue, Mar 26, 2024 at 3:52 PM Adam Wang <adam.wang@jcu.edu.au> wrote:

> Yes, just these 2 target words. So any food or disease should count as a reoccurrence.
>
> Now that I think about it, I assumed that even if this detail was missed from the briefing session, the experimenters should have gleaned or at least suspected this from the instructions alone - participants were asked to ring the bell if any thoughts of a "food" or "disease" comes to mind, so intuitively anything that is a food/disease should have counted, I am perplexed as to why they only counted the 2 words themselves - I'd be curious to know what their thoughts are on this, or whether they suspected anything at all. Hopefully you can ask them and let me know? I guess I should also have reiterated this point multiple times and more specifically just to be safe.
>
> Thanks so much Sarah
> Adam
>
> ---
>
> **From:** Sarah Chan <sarahethanchan@gmail.com>
> **Sent:** Tuesday, March 26, 2024 3:43 PM

To: Adam Wang <adam.wang@jcu.edu.au>
Subject: Re: Scoring strategy for Wang et al RRR on the ironic effects of thought suppression

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Hi Adam,

I'll check in with them, hopefully they are still able to help out! Just to clarify, the re-coding is only needed for the non-discrete words **food** and **disease** right?

Thanks,
Sarah

On Tue, Mar 26, 2024 at 3:36 PM Adam Wang <adam.wang@jcu.edu.au> wrote:

Hi Sarah

Thanks for flagging this up early, unfortunately we cannot use the data if it is coded this way. Are you able to get the experimenters to do the coding again?

Cheers
Adam

From: Sarah Chan <sarahethanchan@gmail.com>
Sent: Tuesday, March 26, 2024 3:18 PM
To: Adam Wang <adam.wang@jcu.edu.au>
Subject: Re: Scoring strategy for Wang et al RRR on the ironic effects of thought suppression

> This message was sent from someone external to JCU. Please do not click links or open attachments unless you recognise the source of this email and know the content is safe.

Hi Adam,

Apologies if this causes more confusion/extra work but I wanted to let you know that our team at NTU coded all of Study 2's target words (gorilla, tiger, food, disease) in the discrete form where only the exact word was counted. That is, for food and diseases we did not count related words like food, pizza, ice cream etc. Sorry if we had overlooked the differentiation between discrete and non-discrete - unfortunately I don't recall this bit from the briefing session and it wasn't stated in the manuscript/coding sheet.

I hope you'll be able to use our data anyway. If re-coding is needed, please let me know and I'll try to work something out.

Thanks and best,
Sarah

On Mon, Mar 25, 2024 at 11:53 PM Adam Wang <adam.wang@jcu.edu.au> wrote:

Hi Ian

Just to clarify, while I am unable to provide a comprehensive coding guide, if your concern is specifically to do with what words should be counted in Study 2, then there is a clear, relatively non-subjective answer, as I mentioned in the briefing session. For the discrete words gorilla and tiger, only the word itself should count. I.e., gorilla, gorillas, big gorilla, should all count, but chimpanzee, monkey, apes, primate etc should not count. For the 2 non-discrete target words food and diseases, anything in these categories should count. I.e., food, pizza, ice cream, Krispy Kreme donuts, all count, while anything that is not a food should not count, such as kitchen, cooking, water, detergent etc. This was the variation from the original study we added in order to achieve better ecological validity (e.g., when we try to suppress food-related thoughts while dieting, we don't just suppress a single word, but the whole category).

Let me just reiterate what I mentioned in the briefing session: there is still an element of subjectivity simply because some words are in the grey area, such as Subway (subway the transportation system or the food?), McDonald's (did the participant refer only to the landmark as in they passes by the place while jogging, or are they referring to the food items?), and Spirulina (technically is it a food, supplement, or marine organism?). It is impossible for me to come up with a one size fits all document for all possible such grey areas, and hence why I mentioned that there will inevitably be some subjectivity, and the coders should exercise their academic judgement and try to reach a consensus first. Any irreconcilable differences can then be resolved by the lab leader(s), and if still unsuccessful, I'd be happy to step in.

I hope this resolves the issue, but if there are further questions, feel free to raise them.

All the best!
Adam

From: ian.hussey@unibe.ch <ian.hussey@unibe.ch>
Sent: Monday, March 25, 2024 11:18 PM
To: malte.elson@unibe.ch <malte.elson@unibe.ch>; Adam Wang <adam.wang@jcu.edu.au>; mhagger@ucmerced.edu <mhagger@ucmerced.edu>; rmajeed2@ucmerced.edu <rmajeed2@ucmerced.edu>; zgriffith@ucmerced.edu <zgriffith@ucmerced.edu>; siegfried.dewitte@kuleuven.be <siegfried.dewitte@kuleuven.be>; florian.lange@kuleuven.be <florian.lange@kuleuven.be>; zhang.x@pku.edu.cn <zhang.x@pku.edu.cn>; wangzuojun_psych@163.com <wangzuojun_psych@163.com>; xusihua80@gmail.com <xusihua80@gmail.com>; lzhua1018@163.com <lzhua1018@163.com>; zhichenglin@gmail.com <zhichenglin@gmail.com>; kuyixuan@mail.sysu.edu.cn <kuyixuan@mail.sysu.edu.cn>; laurent.begue-shankland@univ-grenoble-alpes.fr <laurent.begue-shankland@univ-grenoble-alpes.fr>; jlegal@parisnanterre.fr <jlegal@parisnanterre.fr>; sophiaweissgerber@gmail.com <sophiaweissgerber@gmail.com>; joachim.hueffmeier@tu-dortmund.de <joachim.hueffmeier@tu-dortmund.de>; ann-kathrin.torka@tu-dortmund.de <ann-kathrin.torka@tu-dortmund.de>; angela.fiedler@stud.uni-bamberg.de <angela.fiedler@stud.uni-bamberg.de>; asteria.devy@unpad.ac.id <asteria.devy@unpad.ac.id>; cleo.yusainy@ub.ac.id <cleo.yusainy@ub.ac.id>; Andrian.Liem@monash.edu <Andrian.Liem@monash.edu>; laelatussyifa.sa@staff.uns.ac.id <laelatussyifa.sa@staff.uns.ac.id>; saarbul@sissa.it <saarbul@sissa.it>; irene.mammarella@unipd.it <irene.mammarella@unipd.it>; sara.caviola@unipd.it <sara.caviola@unipd.it>; hookeat.wong@nottingham.edu.my <hookeat.wong@nottingham.edu.my>; j.buczny@vu.nl <j.buczny@vu.nl>; anna.czarna@uj.edu.pl <anna.czarna@uj.edu.pl>; barbu.chris@gmail.com <barbu.chris@gmail.com>; andreeh@smu.edu.sg <andreeh@smu.edu.sg>; psyjl@nus.edu.sg <psyjl@nus.edu.sg>; sarahethanchan@gmail.com <sarahethanchan@gmail.com>;

sanser.yener@bilgiedu.net <sanser.yener@bilgiedu.net>; idil.isik@bilgi.edu.tr <idil.isik@bilgi.edu.tr>; gbm4@lehigh.edu <gbm4@lehigh.edu>; als817@lehigh.edu <als817@lehigh.edu>; christine.ma-kellams@sjsu.edu <christine.ma-kellams@sjsu.edu>; bjschmeichel@gmail.com <bjschmeichel@gmail.com>; christopher.hawk@digipen.edu <christopher.hawk@digipen.edu>; bwilkows@uwyo.edu <bwilkows@uwyo.edu>; rlopez1@wpi.edu <rlopez1@wpi.edu>; cbaldwin@georgiasouthern.edu <cbaldwin@georgiasouthern.edu>; kkim01@wesleyan.edu <kkim01@wesleyan.edu>; bjlevy3@usfca.edu <bjlevy3@usfca.edu>; dcalvill@csusm.edu <dcalvill@csusm.edu>; akira.miyake@colorado.edu <akira.miyake@colorado.edu>; sgregorilabarta@ucsd.edu <sgregorilabarta@ucsd.edu>; ehirt@indiana.edu <ehirt@indiana.edu>; rayem@iu.edu <rayem@iu.edu>; madison.linden1@gmail.com <madison.linden1@gmail.com>; ckoch@georgefox.edu <ckoch@georgefox.edu>; bradyst@wfu.edu <bradyst@wfu.edu>; jared.g.branch@gmail.com <jared.g.branch@gmail.com>; marilia_prada@iscte-iul.pt <marilia_prada@iscte-iul.pt>; msaraiva@ispa.pt <msaraiva@ispa.pt>
Subject: Scoring strategy for Wang et al RRR on the ironic effects of thought suppression

> This message was sent from someone external to JCU. Please do not click links or open attachments unless you recognise the source of this email and know the content is safe.

Dear co-authors,

I'm contacting you as co-authors of Adam Wang's RRR on the ironic effects of thought suppression.

Malte Elson and I are co-authors on this project who are collecting data at the University of Bern, Switzerland. To mention our backgrounds, both Malte and I have been involved in or lead multiple multisite registered replication studies before. We've seen the sorts of problems that can rear their head when it comes to scoring, analysing, reporting, and interpreting the final results, and we think we have found one here which it might be important (i.e. scientifically useful) to resolve before we have all seen one-another's data. We'd therefore like to discuss it with you all as coauthors. We have, of course, discussed these potential issues with Adam first.

When we got to the point of scoring the data from Study 2, we ran into some issues about how to instruct our research assistants how to score the data. I discussed this with Adam, who says that because some of the stimuli are quite different from the original studies (e.g., disease and food are broad categories compared to the original concrete nouns like 'bear') that he was unsure what kind of responses we would get and were not in a place to devise an extensive scoring guide, and that the coders would need to exercise their own judgement. We think this is quite undesirable, as this project is presented and will be read as a highly confirmatory study where lack of clarity or experimenter degrees of freedom are undesirable and weaken the severity of the test.

Relatedly, the first page of the Stage 1 RR calls it "direct replication", though it also says we are running "variants of" the studies by Wegner et al. We think there should be some clarity how we are going to communicate the results, whatever they may look like.

Additionally, the planned analyses include consideration of heterogeneity in the effect. Heterogeneity between sites in multisite replications has caused a lot of discussion in the last

decade, as it's often presented as evidence of hidden moderators. In this case, we are in a position to be able to attribute (some of) any such heterogeneity to genuine differences in methods (i.e., scoring strategies) rather than differences in the strength of the effect between populations, or hidden moderators between sites.

We'd therefore like to ask each site what broad scoring strategy you have employed, or plan to employ, to score the data for study 2 using the following google form (https://forms.gle/EhBbpgdQz7xham8b9). It's just two questions, it should only take you a minute to complete.

Broadly speaking, we see two main ways of scoring the data:
- Narrow scoring strategy, using utterances of the precise target word only
- Broad scoring strategy, which counts references to the target *category* beyond the word itself

Using a narrow scoring strategy, if the participant said the word "chocolate" when the target was "food", this would not count as a mention. Using a broad scoring strategy, it would.

We suspect that the narrow strategy would be more reliable but less valid, and the broad category would be less reliable but possibly more valid. We're going to check this by scoring our data both ways and checking the reliability and the distribution of scores between them.

We'd like to put together this data (i.e., the same data score two ways) with the results of the survey of how other labs have already done this (or plan to do it) to get a sense of the whether not constraining this choice further is likely to introduce heterogeneity and uncertainty into the effect. Adam has said that he would not like to ask sites to rescore their data given the time that this takes. We're conducting this survey and rescoring of our own data as a potentially useful prior step that could speak to whether such a rescoring would be useful or needed (agnostic to whether it is done inside the Wang et al manuscript or in some follow up).

Best wishes
Ian & Malte

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Dr. Ian Hussey
Postdoctoral researcher

University of Bern
Institute of Psychology
Psychology of Digitalisation
Fabrikstrasse 8, D263
3012 Bern, Switzerland

P: +41 31 684 5799
www.dig.psy.unibe.ch
mmmdata.io